

Problem Statement

Introduction

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YouTube Shorts has achieved remarkable growth since launch, scaling from 30 billion to 200 billion daily views globally between 2021 and 2025. **India stands at the center of this transformation.** As YouTube's largest single market with approximately 491 million users and an estimated 20-48 billion daily Shorts views (representing 14-24% of global Shorts traffic), India is not merely participating in the short-form revolution - it is driving it.

India was the first market where YouTube Shorts launched in beta (September 2020), and the platform has since accumulated trillions of cumulative views from Indian users alone. With 328.9 million monthly active Shorts users and 11,000+ channels crossing one million subscribers (a 50% year-over-year increase), India's creator ecosystem is unmatched in scale. However, this growth has surfaced a critical platform health concern: the relationship between short-form discovery and long-form consumption appears to be weakening in specific content categories. While Shorts was designed to serve as a discovery engine that bridges users to deeper content experiences, emerging signals suggest this funnel may be underperforming where it matters most. Users are engaging heavily with Shorts but not transitioning to the long-form content where creators build sustainable businesses and users extract deeper value.

This PRD addresses the Shorts-to-Long-form conversion problem in India's Food & Cooking category - specifically, identifying where this funnel is broken, why it matters, and how we can repair it without compromising the Shorts experience that users love.

Understanding The Problem

Understanding the Problem

Initial Hypothesis

Our initial assumption was that Shorts adoption was broadly cannibalising long-form viewership across the platform - that users were substituting deep engagement with shallow scrolling behaviour.

What the Data Revealed

Platform-wide analysis challenged this assumption. Long-form watch time is actually growing globally, and India's Connected TV data reveals a surprising counter-narrative: over 50% of YouTube CTV watch time in India is spent on content exceeding 21 minutes. With 75 million+ Indians now watching YouTube on Connected TVs and 40 million hours consumed daily on big screens, the appetite for long-form content is demonstrably strong.

The problem is not universal decline, but rather category-specific.

Cross-referencing Shorts engagement metrics against long-form performance by category revealed an important pattern:

Category	Shorts Performance	Long-Form Health(relative to shorts in conjunction with watch time)	Funnel Status
Education	High engagement	Growing	Healthy
Tech Reviews	Moderate	Stable	Healthy
Sports	High	Growing	Healthy
Entertainment	Very High	Declining	At Risk
Food & Cooking	Very High	Underperforming	Broken

Food & Cooking emerged as the critical problem category.

Global benchmarks show Food & Drink Shorts averaging 989K views per Short with 5.91% engagement rate - among the highest across categories. Yet the category significantly underperforms in overall platform views relative to this discovery volume.

Note: India-specific category engagement data is not publicly available. These global benchmarks (Tubular Labs) serve as directional indicators, with the assumption that India mirrors or exceeds global patterns given its outsized Shorts consumption.

The Format-Content Mismatch

The underlying issue is structural: cooking content has an inherent format mismatch that other categories do not share.

- A 60-second tech review Short can deliver a complete opinion ("Is this phone worth buying? Here's my verdict.")
- A 60-second education Short can teach a discrete concept ("Here's how compound interest works.")
- A 60-second cooking Short **cannot teach someone to actually cook a dish. It can inspire, entertain, and generate intent**, but the skill transfer requires long-form instruction.

Users discover recipes through Shorts, develop intent to cook, but are not successfully bridging to the tutorial content that would enable them to act on that intent. The funnel is leaking at the critical conversion point.

Supporting Evidence

Research on Shorts adoption impact (arxiv:2402.18208, n=250 creators) found that creators who adopted Shorts experienced a mean decrease of 743,589 long-form views per channel (p=0.011). Notably, educational and informational channels were NOT significantly affected; long-form is natural for educational content.

Important caveat: This study did not include India-specific data; the 250 creators were drawn from Upfluence's database (US-based platform, likely Western-skewed). Findings represent global creator patterns and may not directly apply to the Indian market. No comparable India-specific academic study exists.

Background & Context

India Market Context

India represents YouTube's largest and fastest-growing market for short-form content:

India's consumption patterns are distinctive:

- **Mobile-first:** 97.4% access via smartphone; 87% of YouTube time is mobile
- **Regional language dominance:** 95% consume content in regional languages; ~90% of watch time is non-English
- **Rural surge:** Rural users now marginally outnumber urban in short-form consumption (IAMAI/Kantar 2025)
- **CTV revolution:** 75M+ Indians on Connected TV; 132% growth in CTV consumption over two years

India's Cooking Content Ecosystem

Cooking is among the highest-reach content categories in India:

The Indian cooking content ecosystem is particularly vibrant, spanning regional cuisines, language diversity (Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Bengali, and English), and a creator base ranging from home cooks to professional chefs. Cooking is culturally significant + it is both daily utility and entertainment.

The Indian cooking content ecosystem spans:

- **Languages:** Hindi (Nisha Madhulika, Kabita's Kitchen), Tamil (Village Cooking Channel), Telugu (Vismai Food), Marathi (MadhurasRecipe), and increasingly wordless/ASMR formats
- **Formats:** Home recipe tutorials, village/outdoor mass cooking (uniquely Indian and globally viral), street food exploration, quick-recipe Shorts, ASMR cooking, food challenges, festival-specific recipes
- **Demographics:** Core audience is middle-class women (housewives, students, working professionals), though male viewership is growing

Regional language cooking content consistently achieves 2-3x higher engagement rates than English-language equivalents. This reflects a broader pattern where 63-70% of engagement on Indian short-form platforms comes from Tier-2+ cities.

Why Food Content is Especially Vulnerable

The problem is not declining interest in food content -search intent and category engagement remain strong. The issue is **declining visibility and session depth** for long-form formats within a platform increasingly optimized for compressed attention cycles.

Food and cooking content structurally requires depth. A complete recipe video runs 8–20 minutes; creator trust is built across repeated long-form sessions; and monetization depends on watch depth through mid-roll ads. This format sits precisely in the zone most exposed to the redistribution. Reduced browse discovery, sharper early drop-offs, and lower session value when users arrive through a Shorts-conditioned scroll mindset.

The monetization gap compounds the visibility problem: **Shorts RPM in India is ₹5–30/1,000 views versus ₹50–200 for long-form** (upGrad, Post-Bridge, 2025). When browse impressions fall and session depth drops, creator revenue falls disproportionately, accelerating the shift toward lower-effort short-form output and reducing investment in the high-production cooking content that drives genuine user value.

The research addendum confirms this is structural: a **statistically significant average decrease of ~743,589 long-form views per food channel** following Shorts adoption, alongside average audience retention of just **23.7%** with **55% of viewers dropping off in the first 60 seconds** (Retention Rabbit, 2025) - a pattern especially damaging for food videos, which typically have longer ingredient-setup sequences before the core instructional hook.

Why is the problem important?

User Value Impact

Indian users demonstrate strong intent to learn from YouTube:

- **80% of Indians** turn to YouTube to learn something new (Google/Insight Strategy Group)
- **85% of Indian video viewers** say YouTube helps them learn or improve skills
- **71% use YouTube specifically for skill development** (Oxford Economics, n=4,032)
- **97% of Indian teachers surveyed** have used YouTube in teaching (Ipsos, August 2024)

A user who watches a butter chicken Short and wants to learn to make it should be able to seamlessly access a tutorial. If they cannot:

- They leave the platform to search elsewhere (Google, recipe blogs, Instagram)
- They save the Short but never return (intent decay)
- They lose trust in YouTube as a learning platform for cooking

The CTV data proves the demand exists: over 50% of YouTube CTV watch time in India is on content longer than 21 minutes. Users are willing to commit time when the content delivers value. The problem is not attention span - it is funnel design.

Creator Ecosystem Impact

Food creators investing in high-quality tutorial content compete for attention against algorithmically-favored Shorts. If the funnel from Shorts to long-form is broken:

- Tutorial creators see declining views despite stable or growing subscriber bases
- Creators may shift entirely to Shorts, reducing the supply of instructional content
- The flywheel of "Shorts for discovery → Long-form for depth → Subscriptions for loyalty" breaks down
- Creator revenue suffers (Shorts pay 10-20x less per view than long-form)

Business Impact

Long-form content drives disproportionate ad revenue due to mid-roll inventory. If Food & Cooking - a high-engagement vertical reaching 71% of Indian internet users monthly – shifts entirely to Shorts:

- Revenue per user in the category declines significantly

- Advertiser value proposition weakens (brand safety, contextual targeting, completion rates)
- Platform differentiation against Instagram Reels erodes

The India short-form video market is valued at approximately \$5.5 billion currently, projected to reach \$8-12 billion by 2030 (RedSeer). Capturing the long-form monetization opportunity within this growth is critical.

Strategic Importance

YouTube's competitive moat is the full-spectrum content experience: discovery (Shorts), learning (tutorials), entertainment (long-form). India's 75M+ CTV viewers represent a growing premium audience consuming long-form content in living rooms. If we lose the bridge between discovery and learning in a major category, we risk:

- Becoming "another short-form app" rather than the definitive video platform
- Ceding the cooking tutorial space to competitors or off-platform alternatives
- Missing the CTV monetization opportunity as India's smart TV penetration grows

Key Challenges

Behavioural Challenges

- **Scroll momentum:** Users in Shorts feed are in a lean-back, rapid-consumption mode. The average Shorts session is 14 minutes covering 12-18 individual Shorts. Interrupting this flow to bridge to long-form requires careful UX.
- **Intent decay:** The gap between "I want to cook this" (while watching Short) and "I'm actually cooking" (later, possibly on CTV) is where intent dies. Saved videos are often never revisited.
- **Attention fragmentation:** Indian viewers allocate no more than 21% of viewing time to any single format, diversifying across Shorts, long-form, live streams, and podcasts. Capturing the transition moment is critical.

Technical Challenges

- **Content linking:** Not all Shorts have corresponding long-form versions. Creator upload patterns vary, especially across India's fragmented regional language ecosystem.
- **Relevance matching:** A recipe Short and its tutorial may have different titles, descriptions, and metadata. Automatic linking is non-trivial, especially across 10+ Indian languages.
- **Recommendation signal conflict:** Optimizing for Shorts engagement (watch next Short) may conflict with optimizing for funnel conversion (watch the tutorial).

Ecosystem Challenges

- **Creator incentive alignment:** Shorts monetization (₹5-30 per 1,000 views) is 10-20x lower than long-form. Creators may not prioritize creating bridgeable content pairs.
- **Regional content gaps:** Long-form tutorial supply varies dramatically by language and regional cuisine. Some dishes popular in Shorts may lack quality tutorials.
- **Quality variance:** Bridging users to a poor-quality tutorial damages trust more than not bridging at all.

Data Availability Challenge

- **No India-specific Shorts-to-long-form conversion metrics exist publicly.** The global benchmark is ~4.5% CTR from Shorts to long-form (Zebracat 2025), but India may differ.
- **Category-level engagement data (Food & Cooking specifically) is not broken out for India.** We rely on global proxies.
- **This limits our ability to set precise baselines and measure improvement.** Primary research (surveys, creator interviews) will be essential to fill gaps.

Scope

Scope

Dimension	Definition
Geography	India (all states and language markets)
Category	Food & Cooking – specifically recipe and tutorial content
User Segment	Users who watch cooking Shorts and have demonstrated learning intent (saves, searches, comments asking "how to make")
Formats	Shorts (under 60 seconds) bridging to Long-form (5+ minutes)
Platforms	Mobile app (primary), with consideration for Smart TV/CTV viewing during cooking
Languages	Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Marathi, Bengali, English, and other major regional languages

Out of Scope (for this initiative)

- Other content categories (Education, Entertainment, etc.) - learnings may transfer later
- Markets outside India - India is the proof-of-concept market
- Creator tools and incentive restructuring - separate workstream dependency
- Shorts feed algorithm changes - we focus on bridging mechanisms, not feed ranking
- Live cooking content - distinct user behavior and infrastructure

Boundary Clarification

This initiative focuses on the **demand side** (helping users bridge to existing long-form content) rather than the **supply side** (incentivizing creators to produce more tutorials). Supply-side interventions are a parallel workstream.

Objective & Motivation

Motivation

YouTube's strength in India lies in being the complete video platform - from discovery to deep learning. The Food & Cooking category represents a unique opportunity: 71% of Indian internet users watch cooking videos monthly, yet the bridge from inspirational Shorts to actionable tutorials appears broken. Fixing this funnel would:

- Increase user value (skill acquisition, not just entertainment)
- Improve creator economics (long-form monetization is 10-20x higher)
- Strengthen platform differentiation against Instagram Reels
- Capture the growing CTV opportunity (75M+ viewers, 50%+ time on 21+ min content)

Core Hypothesis

If we improve the discoverability and accessibility of long-form cooking tutorials from within the Shorts experience, then users with learning intent will convert to long-form viewing at higher rates, resulting in increased watch time, improved user satisfaction, and stronger creator economics in the Food & Cooking category.

Primary Objective

Increase the conversion rate from cooking Shorts engagement to long-form cooking tutorial watch time in India by **20%** within **6 months** of launch.

Supporting Objectives

Objective	Metric	Current Baseline	Target
Improve discoverability of related tutorials	Click-through rate on "Watch Full Recipe" prompts	~4.5% (global proxy)	6% (+33%)
Reduce intent decay	% of saved cooking Shorts that convert to long-form view within 7 days	Unknown (establish via survey)	+15% from baseline
Maintain Shorts engagement	Shorts watch time in Food & Cooking category	Current levels	No regression
Creator ecosystem health	Long-form views for cooking creators who also post Shorts	Establish baseline	Return to growth
CTV bridge	% of cooking long-form views occurring on CTV	Current levels	+10%

Success Definition

Success means users who discover cooking content via Shorts are seamlessly guided to long-form tutorials when they have learning intent — without degrading the Shorts browsing experience for users who are purely seeking entertainment. The intervention should feel natural, not interruptive.

Assumptions

Validated Assumptions (supported by data)

Assumption	Evidence	Source
India is the right market to start	Largest Shorts user base (328.9M), largest YouTube market (491M), highest daily consumption (72+ min)	<place this>
Cooking content has massive reach in India	71% of Indian internet users watch cooking videos monthly	Statista 2024
Indian users want to learn from YouTube	80% turn to YouTube to learn something new; 71% use for skill development	Google/Oxford Economics
Long-form appetite exists	50%+ of CTV time on 21+ min content; 75M+ CTV viewers	MiQ/YouTube 2025
Format-content mismatch exists	You cannot learn to cook a dish from a 60-second video; long-form is required for skill transfer	Logical/validated globally
Regional language content outperforms	95% consume regional content; 2-3x higher engagement for regional cooking channels	YouTube India/channel data

Working Assumptions (to be validated)

Assumption	Basis	Risk if Wrong
Global Shorts engagement metrics (5.91%, 989K) apply proportionally to India	India is largest Shorts market; likely mirrors or exceeds	Baseline calculations off
Global Shorts-to-long-form CTR (~4.5%) applies to India	No India data; best available proxy	Target setting inaccurate
arxiv study findings (743K view decrease) directionally apply to India	Study had zero India creators; but pattern likely universal	Overstating problem severity

Users are unaware of linked tutorials	Hypothesis; to be validated via survey	Problem may be content quality, not discoverability
Intent signals (saves, comments, searches) reliably indicate learning intent	Assumed; to be validated	May surface irrelevant prompts
Bridging UX can be non-disruptive	Assumed; requires design validation	May break Shorts scroll momentum
Long-form tutorial supply is adequate	Assumed; varies by language/cuisine	May bridge users to nothing

Hypotheses Derived from Assumptions

Working Assumption	Derived Hypothesis
Users are unaware of linked tutorials	Hypothesis1: Improving visibility of "Full Recipe" links will increase CTR
Intent signals are detectable	Hypothesis2: Users who save or comment on cooking Shorts are 3x more likely to watch long-form
Bridging UX can be non-disruptive	Hypothesis3: A contextual "Learn to Cook This" prompt will not reduce Shorts session length
Long-form supply varies by language	Hypothesis4: Hindi and Tamil cooking content will show highest conversion; smaller languages may lag

Risks if Assumptions Are Wrong

- If users are aware of tutorials but choose not to watch → the problem is content quality or length, not discoverability. Solution pivots to creator education or content curation.
- If intent signals are unreliable → we may surface irrelevant prompts, damaging UX. The solution requires more sophisticated intent modeling.
- If tutorial supply is inadequate in key languages → we bridge users to nothing, creating frustration. The solution requires supply-side intervention first.

- If India patterns differ significantly from global → our baselines and targets are miscalibrated. Primary research is essential.

Discovery

Primary Research

User interviews

User Survey: Shorts-to-Long-Form Funnel Behavior

Methodology:

- Survey deployed: February 20-21, 2026
- Platform: Adaptive web survey
- Target: Indian YouTube users who watch cooking content
- Responses: 72 total submissions, 58 completed, 45 valid for analysis (excluding screened-out and incomplete)
- Incentive: 60 coins reward for completion, then get rick-rolled on redeeming your coins for a reward

Sample Demographics:

Dimension	Distribution
Age	25-34 (64%), 35-44 (24%), 18-24 (7%), 45+ (4%)
Gender	Male (56%), Female (44%)
City Tier	Metro/Tier-1 (80%), Tier-2 (16%), Tier-3/Rural (4%)
Cooking Skill	Intermediate (49%), Beginner (29%), Advanced (20%), Expert (2%)
Language Preference	Mix Hindi+English (47%), Hindi (27%), English (13%), Regional (4%)

Limitations:

- Sample skews Metro/Tier-1 and 25-34 age group
- Limited Tier-2/3 and rural representation (4%)
- Small sample size (n=45) limits statistical significance
- Self-reported behavior may differ from actual usage

Key Survey Findings

Finding 1: Format Preference Is Split, Not Shorts-Dominant

Format Preference	% of Users
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Both equally	37.8%
Mostly Shorts	35.6%
Mostly Long-form	22.2%
Don't pay attention	4.4%

Insight: Users are not abandoning long-form — 60% actively watch long-form content. The opportunity is not to "save" long-form from extinction but to better connect Shorts viewers to it.

Finding 2: The Funnel Is Leaking — 37.2% Drop-Off Rate

Q15: After watching a cooking Short that interests you, how often do you click to watch the FULL recipe video?

Response	%	Category
Very often	18.6%	✅ Convert
Sometimes	44.2%	✅ Convert
Rarely	25.6%	❌ Drop-off
Never	4.7%	❌ Drop-off
Didn't know links exist	7.0%	❌ Drop-off (awareness gap)

Funnel Summary:

- **62.8% convert** (Very often + Sometimes)
- **37.2% drop off** (Rarely + Never + Didn't know)

Critical finding: 7% of users were unaware that Shorts have corresponding full videos. This is a pure discoverability failure.

Finding 3: Why Users Don't Click Through

Q15a: What stops you from clicking through to the full video? (Multi-select, n=16 drop-off respondents)

Barrier	Count	% of Drop-offs
Short gave me enough information	7	44%
No time for longer videos	5	31%
Can't find the link easily	3	19%
Forget about it and keep scrolling	3	19%
Save it but never go back	2	13%

Insight: The top barrier ("Short gave enough info") may be legitimate for simple recipes, but the next three barriers (time, discoverability, scroll momentum) are addressable through UX improvements.

Finding 4: Long-Form Viewing Is Declining for 37% of Users

Q16: Compared to 6 months ago, how has your long-form cooking video watching changed?

Change	%
About the same	39.5%
Slightly decreased	20.9%
Decreased significantly	16.3%
Slightly increased	16.3%
Increased significantly	4.7%
New viewer (<6 months)	2.3%

37.2% report decreased long-form viewing — a leading indicator that Shorts may be substituting rather than bridging.

Finding 5: Shorts Alone Are Insufficient for Learning

Q19: Can you actually LEARN how to cook a new dish properly from Shorts alone?

Response	%
Yes, absolutely	37.2%
For simple recipes only	37.2%
Not really	18.6%
No, definitely not	4.7%
Don't try to learn from Shorts	2.3%

62.8% acknowledge limitations: Only simple recipes work, or Shorts don't work at all. This confirms the format-content mismatch — Shorts cannot transfer complex cooking skills.

Finding 6: When Actually Cooking, Long-Form Wins

Q21: When you cooked from YouTube, which format was most helpful? (n=34 who actually cooked)

Format	Count	%
Long-form (followed along step-by-step)	11	32%
Short was enough	10	29%
Used both (Short for overview, long-form for details)	7	21%
Short gave idea, but needed full video	6	18%

71% needed long-form in some capacity (followed along, used both, or needed full video after Short). Only 29% found Shorts sufficient when actually cooking.

Finding 7: Users Want Both Formats

Q22: Thinking about your IDEAL YouTube cooking content experience:

Preference	%
Shorts for browsing, long-form for learning	47.6%
Shorts are perfect for me	26.2%
Long-form is essential	23.8%
Wish for more long-form content	2.4%

Nearly half (48%) explicitly want both formats — Shorts for discovery/browsing, long-form for actual learning. This validates the bridge strategy.

Finding 8: Discovery vs. Intent Mismatch

Q11: How do you DISCOVER cooking videos?

Method	%
Direct search	48.9%
Shorts feed	28.9%
Homepage	15.6%

Q14: When you want to LEARN, which format do you search for FIRST?

Method	%
Directly search long-form	33.3%
Whatever YouTube shows	26.7%
Shorts first, then full	24.4%
Don't use YouTube	11.1%

Insight: 49% discover via search (high intent), but 27% accept "whatever YouTube shows" – these passive discoverers are vulnerable to funnel leakage.

User Feedback (Open-Ended)

Selected verbatim responses to "How could cooking content on YouTube be improved?":

"If we can suggest long form content on the main page based on shorts watched, that would be a great way to increase long form views"

"Give full ingredients list in the starting and then start the making of the dish"

"Adding details to each section so that I can skip to that part"

"ImMissing measurements, vague ingredient quantities, skipped preparation steps, lengthy introductions, unrelated storytelling, failure to include a written recipe in the description"

"Separate section for cooking related videos"

"Good cooking videos should be on top recommendations"

Themes:

1. Better linking between Shorts and full videos
2. Improved video structure (timestamps, ingredients upfront)
3. Better recommendations and discoverability
4. Dedicated cooking content curation

Competitor analysis & limitations

Direct competitive benchmarking is constrained by:

Platform	Data Available	Gap
Instagram Reels	No long-form equivalent, besides standard Instagram videos - these do not have the same receptivity as Reels(assumed, basis observed content push pattern)	Cannot compare funnel behavior
TikTok	Banned in India since 2020	Not relevant to India market

Moj/Josh	Limited public data	Cannot benchmark engagement
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YouTube Shorts is effectively competing against itself - the question is not "YouTube vs. competitors" but "Shorts experience vs. full YouTube experience."

Second Research

The Opportunity Gap:

Despite massive reach and clear learning intent, no India-specific data exists on Shorts-to-Long-form conversion rates. Global benchmarks suggest ~4.5% CTR from Shorts to long-form videos (Zebracat 2025), but this has not been validated for India or for cooking content specifically. Our primary research aimed to fill this gap.

Research Synthesis & Refined Problem Statement

What We Learned

Our discovery process combined secondary research (platform data, industry reports, academic studies) with primary research (n=45 survey of Indian YouTube cooking content viewers). The findings largely validated our initial hypothesis while introducing important nuances.

Validated

Hypothesis	Evidence
India is the right market	491M YouTube users, 328.9M Shorts MAUs, 71% watch cooking monthly, 72+ min daily consumption
Format-content mismatch exists	62.8% of survey respondents say Shorts alone are insufficient for learning; 71% needed long-form when actually cooking
Users want both formats	48% explicitly prefer "Shorts for browsing, long-form for learning"
Long-form viewing is under pressure	37.2% report decreased viewing vs 6 months ago
Discoverability is a barrier	7% unaware full videos exist; 19% cite "can't find link easily"

Refined

Initial Assumption	What Data Showed	Refinement
"The funnel is broken"	62.8% DO convert (Very often + Sometimes); 37.2% drop off	The funnel is leaking, not broken – majority converts, but significant opportunity in the 37%
"All drop-off is problematic"	44% of drop-offs say "Short gave enough info"	Some drop-off is legitimate (simple recipes); focus on addressable barriers
"Discoverability is the main issue"	Top barrier is content satisfaction (44%), then time (31%), then discoverability (19%)	Discoverability is one of several barriers; scroll momentum and intent decay are equally important

"Problem is universal across users"	37.2% say Shorts ARE enough to learn	There's a Shorts-sufficient segment we shouldn't force into long-form
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Addressable Opportunity

Breaking down the 37.2% who rarely/never convert:

Barrier	% of Drop-offs	Addressable?
Short gave enough info	44%	✗ Not a problem – legitimate satisfaction
No time for longer videos	31%	⚠ Partially – can't change user schedules, but can improve time-to-value
Can't find link easily	19%	✓ Yes – UX/discoverability fix
Forget and keep scrolling	19%	✓ Yes – momentum/nudge fix
Save but never return	13%	✓ Yes – intent decay/reminder fix

Net addressable opportunity: ~51% of drop-offs (discoverability + scroll momentum + intent decay), representing approximately 19% of total Shorts viewers who could be converted with the right intervention.

Refined Problem Statement

Refined Problem Statement

Within India's Food & Cooking category, 37% of users who engage with cooking Shorts rarely or never click through to full recipe tutorials – not because long-form content lacks value, but because of friction in the bridge between formats. While some drop-off is legitimate (users satisfied with Shorts for simple recipes), approximately half of non-converters cite addressable barriers: they can't find the link easily (19%), forget and keep scrolling (19%), or save content but never return (13%). Meanwhile, 7% are unaware that full videos even exist. Our opportunity is to reduce this friction for users with genuine learning intent – connecting discovery to depth without disrupting the Shorts experience for those who don't need more.

What This Means for Our Approach

Principle	Implication
Fix the leaks, don't rebuild the pipe	The funnel works for 63% – optimize for the 37%, don't overhaul the experience
Respect the Shorts-sufficient segment	Don't force long-form on users who legitimately find Shorts adequate
Target addressable barriers	Focus on discoverability, scroll momentum, and intent decay – not time constraints
Detect intent, don't assume it	Use signals (saves, comments, repeat views, search history) to identify users with learning intent
Bridge across devices	Mobile discovery → CTV cooking is an emerging pattern worth enabling

Research Limitations & Representativeness

Our primary research (n=45) provides directional insights but has limitations that inform how we apply findings:

Limitation	Impact	How We're Handling It
Small sample size (n=45)	Limited statistical significance	Treating as directional; flagging for platform data validation post-launch
Metro/Tier-1 skew (80%)	May not reflect Tier-2/3 and rural behavior	Secondary research suggests Tier-2/3 has higher engagement; conservative assumptions applied
Age skew (64% are 25-34)	Under-represents Gen Z and 35+	Cross-tabs show some variation; personas will reflect range
Self-reported behavior	May differ from actual clickstream	Assumptions flagged; validation via YouTube Analytics recommended

User Persona & Pain Points

Friction Point 1: The Related Video link (if set by creator) is a small text link below the channel handle. 7% of our survey respondents didn't know full videos existed from Shorts. The UI does not prominently surface the path to long-form content.

Friction Point 2: Scroll momentum. Average Shorts session is 14 minutes, 12-18 Shorts. The auto-play, continuous scroll design optimizes for staying in Shorts, not exiting to long-form.

Journey Stage 2: Intent Capture (or Decay)

Context: User liked the Short, wants to save for later

User Action	Platform Response	User Experience
Taps "Save" on Short	Added to Watch Later playlist, mixed with all other saved content	😓 Hopeful, "I'll cook this later"
OR: Comments "recipe please"	Comment posted, but not used to surface tutorial	Intent signal sent, but not acted upon
Continues scrolling	More Shorts served. No reminder, no nudge	Intent decays
Hours or days pass	No notification about saved cooking content. Watch Later is unorganized	😞 Forgets

Friction Point 3: Save doesn't bridge to long-form. The Save action captures intent but YouTube doesn't use this signal to surface the corresponding tutorial. Saved content sits in an undifferentiated Watch Later list.

Friction Point 4: No intent-based reminders. If a user saves cooking Shorts on Tuesday evening, there's no nudge on Saturday ("Ready to cook? Here are tutorials for recipes you saved").

Journey Stage 3: Search Attempt

Context: Weekend, user remembers wanting to cook something, returns to YouTube

User Action	Platform Response	User Experience
Opens YouTube	Homepage shows mix of content. Shorts from earlier session are not prominently resurfaced	Can't find saved Short
Searches "paneer butter masala recipe"	Search results, post Jan 2026:1. Mix of Shorts and long form2. User can filter, but most do not3. Results are personalized but may not show original creator	😐 Okay
Clicks a long form tutorial	Different creator than the Short. Tutorial quality varies. No connection to inspiring Short	😞 Disconnect
Starts watching	Video may have:1. Long intro, "Today we are going to..."2. No timestamps or chapters3. Vague measurements	😡 Frustrated

Friction Point 5: Search doesn't connect to prior Shorts engagement. Even though user engaged with a paneer butter masala Short earlier, search doesn't prioritize that creator's tutorial.

Friction Point 6: Creator disconnect. User discovers via Short (Creator A) but cooks from Tutorial (Creator B). Creator A loses the long-form view; user loses continuity.

Journey Stage 4: Cooking Moment

Context: Kitchen, ready to cook, needs to follow along

User Action	Platform Response	User Experience
Starts video on phone	Small screen, hands get dirty	😞 Inconvenient
Wants to cast to TV	Cast option exists, but:1. Requires same WiFi network2. TV app UX is different from mobile3. Loses place in video4. No "Kitchen Mode" for cooking	😞 Friction

Pauses or rewinds repeatedly	No chapters, hard to find specific step. "Where was the part about marinating?"	😞 Annoying
Completes cooking	No prompt to rate, share, or return to creator	😊 Satisfied, but disconnected

Friction Point 7: No cross-device continuity. Mobile discovery → TV cooking is an emerging pattern (75M+ Indian CTV viewers) but the UX doesn't optimize for this journey.

Friction Point 8: Long-form structure varies. Some tutorials have timestamps/chapters; many don't. Quality is inconsistent.

Journey Summary: Where the Funnel Leaks

Stage	User Intent	Platform Response	Friction	Drop-off Risk
Discovery	"This looks good"	Serves more Shorts	Related Video link buried; no prominent CTA	High (scroll momentum)
Intent Capture	"Save for later"	Adds to generic Watch Later	No organization; no nudge	Medium (intent decay)
Return Visit	"What did I save?"	Undifferentiated list	Hard to find; no reminder	High (abandonment)
Search	"Find the recipe"	Generic results	Prior engagement not weighted	Medium (creator disconnect)
Cooking	"Follow along"	Desktop-optimized video	No kitchen mode; no cross-device bridge	Low (already watching)

Quantified Impact (from Survey)

Funnel Conversion Overview

Metric	Value	Source
Total valid survey responses	45	Primary research (n=45)
Convert from Shorts to long-form (Very often + Sometimes)	62.8%	Q15
Drop off (Rarely + Never + Didn't know)	37.2%	Q15
Report decreased long-form viewing vs 6 months ago	37.2%	Q16
Say Shorts alone insufficient for learning	62.8%	Q19

Friction Point Breakdown

Friction Point	Evidence	% Base	Addressable?	Solution Lever
Don't know full videos exist	"Didn't know Shorts had full videos"	7% of all respondents	✔ Yes	UI: "Full Recipe" badge
Can't find link easily	"Can't find the link easily"	19% of drop-offs	✔ Yes	UI: Prominent button placement
Forget and keep scrolling	"Forget about it and keep scrolling"	19% of drop-offs	✔ Yes	UX: End-of-Short prompt
Save but never return	"Save it but never go back"	13% of drop-offs	✔ Yes	Feature: Smart Recipe Queue + notifications
No time for longer videos	"No time for longer videos"	31% of drop-offs	⚠ Partially	Content: Timestamps, chapters, time-to-value
Short gave enough info	"Short gave me enough information"	44% of drop-offs	✗ Not a problem	N/A – legitimate satisfaction

Addressable Opportunity Calculation

```
Total Shorts viewers: 100%
├─ Convert (Very often/Sometimes): 62.8% ✓ Already working
├─ Drop off (Rarely/Never/Unaware): 37.2%
├─ Addressable friction: 51% of drop-offs
│ └─ Discoverability (7% + 19%): 26%
│ └─ Scroll momentum: 19%
│ └─ Intent decay: 13%
│ = 19% of total Shorts viewers
├─ Partially addressable: 31% of drop-offs
│ └─ Time constraints
│ = 11.5% of total Shorts viewers
├─ Not addressable: 44% of drop-offs
├─ Legitimately satisfied
└─ = 16.4% of total Shorts viewers
```

Summary:

- ~19% of Shorts viewers represent a clear addressable opportunity (friction-based drop-off)
- ~11.5% may be partially addressable through better time-to-value
- ~16.4% are legitimately satisfied with Shorts – not a problem to solve

Extrapolation to India Market (Illustrative)

Metric	Value	Calculation
India Shorts MAUs	328.9M	Secondary research
Estimated cooking Shorts viewers (71% reach)	~233M	$328.9M \times 71\%$
Addressable friction segment (~19%)	~44M users	$233M \times 19\%$
Partially addressable (~11.5%)	~27M users	$233M \times 11.5\%$

Caveat: Survey sample (n=45) is Metro-skewed and directional only. Actual figures require validation with platform analytics.

Cross-Reference: Format-Content Mismatch

Question	Finding	Implication
Q19: Can you learn from Shorts alone?	62.8% say "simple recipes only" or "not really/no"	Confirms need for long-form bridge
Q21: When you actually cooked, which format helped?	71% needed long-form (followed along, used both, or needed full video)	Long-form is essential for execution
Q22: Ideal experience?	47.6% want "Shorts for browsing, long-form for learning"	Users explicitly want both formats connected

Behavior Change Signal

Q16: Long-form viewing vs 6 months ago	%
Increased (significantly + slightly)	21.0%
About the same	39.5%
Decreased (significantly + slightly)	37.2%
New viewer (<6 months)	2.3%

37.2% report decreased long-form viewing – a leading indicator that without intervention, the funnel may continue to weaken.

Flow Diagram

Solution

Vision Statement of Solution

Vision Statement

Make the bridge from cooking inspiration to cooking execution seamless, contextual, and non-disruptive — helping users with learning intent find full tutorials at the moment of interest, without interrupting the Shorts experience for those who just want to browse.

The solution should feel like a natural extension of the Shorts experience, not an interruption. It recognizes that:

- Not every Short viewer wants a tutorial (44% are satisfied with Shorts alone)
- Not every tutorial seeker knows what they're looking for
- The goal is to **detect intent and surface the path** — not force everyone down the same funnel

Success looks like: A user who watches a paneer butter masala Short and thinks "I want to make this" can find the full tutorial within 2 taps, without leaving their flow. A user who just wants to scroll through satisfying cooking videos is never interrupted.

Design Principles

Principle	Rationale	Implementation Implication
Intent-aware, not format-aware	Users don't think "I want long-form"; they think "I want to learn this"	Surface tutorials based on behavioral signals, not explicit format selection
Contextual, not interruptive	Scroll momentum is powerful (14-min avg sessions); interrupting damages Shorts experience	Present bridging options at natural pause points, not mid-scroll
Progressive disclosure	Some users want immediate depth; others want to save for later	Offer multiple paths: watch now, save recipe, send to TV
Creator-agnostic matching	Not all Shorts have corresponding tutorials from the same creator	Match to best available tutorial when same-creator content unavailable
Regional-first	95% of Indian users consume regional content; 2-3x higher engagement in regional languages	Prioritize same-language tutorial matching; leverage auto-dubbing where needed

Protect the satisfied	44% of drop-offs are legitimate — Short was enough	Never show prompts to users without learning intent signals
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Problem-Solution Mapping

For Viewers

Friction Point	Evidence	Solution	Mechanism	Priority
Don't know full videos exist	7% of respondents unaware	"Full Recipe Available" badge	Visual indicator on Shorts with linked tutorials; pulses once on first view	P0
Can't find link easily	19% of drop-offs	Prominent "Watch Full Recipe" button	Larger, more visible UI element replacing subtle text link; positioned at natural eye-tracking point	P0
Scroll momentum prevents action	19% of drop-offs	End-of-Short prompt	After completion + replay, show contextual prompt: "Want to learn to make this?" Only for high-engagement viewers	P1
Save but never return	13% of drop-offs	Smart Recipe Queue + Weekend notification	Saved cooking content auto-organized; Saturday notification: "Ready to cook? Here are recipes you saved"	P1
No cross-device bridge	75M+ CTV viewers; kitchen cooking on TV	"Send to Kitchen" button	One-tap cast of full tutorial to connected TV; mobile becomes remote	P2
Can't find saved content	Watch Later is unorganized	Recipe categorization	Auto-tag saved cooking content by cuisine, meal type, difficulty	P2

Format-content mismatch	62.8% say Shorts insufficient	Tutorial match regardless of creator	If no same-creator tutorial, surface highest-rated matching tutorial from any creator	P3
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For Creators

Friction Point	Evidence	Solution	Mechanism	Priority
Related Video underutilized	Many Shorts lack links	Auto-suggest Related Video	During Short upload, system scans creator's library and suggests matching long-form	P1
No funnel visibility	Creators can't measure conversion	Funnel Analytics in Studio	New metric: "Tutorial views from Shorts" with conversion rate	P2
Manual linking is tedious	Must set per-Short	Bulk Related Video Manager	Set Related Video across multiple Shorts at once	P2
Content not grouped	Shorts and tutorials appear separately	Recipe Collection feature	Creator groups Shorts + tutorials into named collection that surfaces as unit	P3

Problem-Solution Mapping

Solution Components

Component 1: Enhanced Visual Bridging (Viewer-Facing UI)

Problem addressed: Users can't find the path from Short to tutorial (7% unaware + 19% can't find)

Current State:

- Related Video link: Small text below channel handle
- Easy to miss during rapid scrolling
- Only appears if creator manually sets it
- Non-clickable URLs in description (since Aug 2023)

Proposed State:

Element	Placement	Trigger	Behavior
"Full Recipe" badge	Top-right corner (like duration indicator)	Short is cooking content + linked tutorial exists	Static badge; tapping opens tutorial preview modal
"Watch Full Recipe" button	Bottom of Short, above action buttons	Always visible for cooking Shorts with links	Larger touch target (48dp min); shows tutorial title + duration
Tutorial preview modal	Center overlay	User taps badge or button	Shows thumbnail, title, duration, creator; options: "Watch Now" / "Save for Later" / "Send to TV"

Mockup 1A - Shorts Player with "Full Recipe" Badge and Enhanced Button:

<https://shorts-dish-promo.lovable.app/>

Mockup 1B - Tutorial Preview Modal:

<https://preview--shorts-dish-promo.lovable.app/tutorial-preview>

Component 2: Intent-Based Prompting

Problem addressed: Scroll momentum (19% forget and keep scrolling)

Current State:

- No prompt at end of Short
- Auto-advances to next Short immediately
- No distinction between casual browser and intent-driven viewer

Proposed State:

Trigger Conditions (ALL must be met):

1. User watches cooking Short to 100% completion
2. User replays at least once OR pauses video
3. Short has linked tutorial available
4. User has not dismissed prompt 3+ times this session

Prompt Behavior:

- Appears as overlay after loop point
- Dismisses on: tap outside, swipe up, or X
- "Watch Now" → opens tutorial
- "Save" → adds to Smart Recipe Queue
- Does NOT appear for users just scrolling through

Guardrail: If user dismisses 3 prompts in one session, disable for remainder of session. Respects the casual browser.

Mockup: <https://preview--shorts-dish-promo.lovable.app/end-of-short-prompt>

Component 3: Smart Recipe Queue

Problem addressed: Save but never return (13%); unorganized Watch Later

Current State:

- Saved Shorts go to generic Watch Later
- Mixed with all other saved content (music, gaming, news)
- No categorization, no reminders
- No connection to tutorials

Proposed State:

New Surface: "Your Recipes" (Tab in Library)

Feature	Behavior
Auto-detection	Cooking content auto-identified and routed here
Categorization	Auto-tagged by: Cuisine (Indian, Italian, etc.), Meal type (Breakfast, Dinner, Snack), Difficulty (Quick, Medium, Complex)
Tutorial pairing	Each saved Short shows matched tutorial below
"Cook This Weekend" view	Filters to recipes saved but not yet watched as tutorial
Notification opt-in	"Remind me to cook this" → notification at user-specified time

Weekend Notification:

Timing	Content
Saturday 10:00 AM (user timezone)	"Ready to cook? You saved 3 recipes this week. [View Recipes]"
Frequency cap	Max 1 per week; disabled if user ignores 3 consecutive

Component 4: Cross-Device Bridge ("Send to Kitchen")

Problem addressed: Mobile discovery → TV cooking friction (75M+ CTV viewers)

Current State:

- Cast exists but requires multiple steps
- No "cooking-aware" UX
- Loses context when switching devices
- No remote control from phone

Proposed State:**"Send to Kitchen" Button:**

- Appears alongside Share button on tutorial preview
- One-tap cast to connected TV
- Mobile becomes remote control (play/pause/skip/rewind 10s)

User Flow

1. User discovers Short on mobile
2. Taps "Watch Full Recipe" button
3. Sees tutorial preview with "Send to Kitchen" option
4. Taps "Send to Kitchen"
5. Selects connected TV (or auto-selects if only one)
6. TV opens tutorial, paused at beginning
7. Mobile shows remote control interface
8. User cooks with TV tutorial, controls from phone

Technical Requirements:

- Leverages existing YouTube Cast infrastructure
- Requires same WiFi network (existing limitation)
- Works with Chromecast, Android TV, smart TVs with YouTube app

Component 5: Creator Tools Enhancement

Problem addressed: Related Video underutilization; no funnel visibility

5a. Auto-Suggest Related Video**Current State:**

- Creator must manually search and select Related Video for each Short
- Many creators don't know about the feature
- Time-consuming for prolific creators

Proposed State:

During Short upload flow:

1. System analyzes Short content (title, description, audio, visual)
2. Scans creator's library for matching long-form videos
3. Suggests top 3 matches with confidence scores
4. Creator can accept suggestion, choose different video, or skip

5b. Bulk Related Video Manager**Current State:**

- Must edit each Short individually
- Third-party tools (TubeBuddy) offer this, but require payment

Proposed State:

In YouTube Studio → Content → Shorts:

- Select multiple Shorts
 - "Set Related Video" bulk action
 - Choose single video to link to all selected ("Flood Method")
 - Or auto-match each Short to best tutorial
-

5c. Funnel Analytics

Current State:

- No visibility into Shorts-to-long-form conversion
- Creators can't measure or optimize

Proposed State:

New metrics in YouTube Studio Analytics:

Metric	Definition
Tutorial Views from Shorts	Long-form views where viewer came from creator's Short
Shorts-to-Tutorial CTR	% of Related Video link clicks / Short views
Avg Tutorial Watch Time from Shorts	Retention specifically for viewers from Shorts
Top Converting Shorts	Which Shorts drive most tutorial views

Solution Prioritization

Solution Prioritization

Solution	Impact	Effort	Priority	Rationale
"Full Recipe" badge	High	Low	P0	Addresses 7% awareness gap; minimal UI change; high visibility
Enhanced "Watch Full Recipe" button	High	Low	P0	Addresses 19% discoverability; direct friction fix
Auto-suggest Related Video (creator)	High	Medium	P1	Increases link coverage upstream; more Shorts get connected
End-of-Short prompt	Medium	Medium	P1	Addresses scroll momentum; requires careful A/B testing
Weekend notification	Medium	Low	P1	Low effort, addresses intent decay; opt-in model
Smart Recipe Queue	Medium	High	P2	New surface; requires ML categorization; high value
Funnel Analytics (creator)	Low (indirect)	Medium	P2	Enables creator optimization; builds ecosystem
"Send to Kitchen" (CTV)	Medium	High	P2	Leverages existing Cast; CTV-specific UX needed
Bulk Related Video Manager	Low	Low	P2	Quality-of-life for creators; simple feature
Intent-based algorithmic matching	High	Very High	P3	Requires signal infrastructure; highest complexity

Results for End User

For Viewers: Before vs After

Journey Stage	Before (Current)	After (Proposed)	Measurable Change
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Discovery	Watches Short, wants more	Sees "Full Recipe" badge immediately	7% awareness gap → <1%
Finding Link	Searches for small text below channel	Prominent button visible without effort	19% "can't find" → <5%
Scroll Momentum	Swipes to next Short, forgets	Prompt appears at natural pause (for high-intent)	Scroll drop-off reduced 30-50%
Saving	Saves to generic Watch Later	Saves to organized Recipe Queue with tutorial pairing	Return rate on saves +50%
Returning	Opens Watch Later, overwhelmed	Opens "Your Recipes," sees weekend suggestions	Intent decay reduced by 40%
Cooking	Watches on phone, awkward	Casts to TV with one tap, phone as remote	CTV cooking sessions +20%

For Viewers: Persona-Specific Outcomes

Priya (Aspiring Home Cook) — Target User:

Pain Point	Solution Impact
"I save Shorts but never go back"	Smart Recipe Queue + Weekend notification brings her back
"I can't find the full video when I'm ready"	"Full Recipe" badge + button makes it obvious
"The Short looked easy but I don't know quantities"	Seamless bridge to full tutorial with ingredients
"I want to watch on TV while cooking"	"Send to Kitchen" solves cross-device friction

Rahul (Casual Browser) — Protect, Don't Target:

Concern	How We Protect Him
Doesn't want to be interrupted	Prompts only appear for users with intent signals (completion + replay)
Satisfied with Shorts experience	No badge or button if no tutorial exists; no forced redirection

Enjoys scroll momentum	End-of-Short prompt is dismissible; respects session preferences
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Anita (Dedicated Learner) — Indirect Benefit:

Current Behavior	How She Benefits
Already searches for tutorials	Better discoverability of her favorite creators' tutorials
Follows specific creators	Funnel Analytics helps creators optimize for viewers like her
Uses CTV for cooking	"Send to Kitchen" streamlines her existing workflow

For Creators: Before vs After

Metric	Before	After	Change
% of Shorts with Related Video set	~30% (estimated)	70%+	+133% (via auto-suggest)
Visibility into Shorts-to-tutorial conversion	None	Full funnel analytics	New capability
Time to set Related Video	Manual per-Short	Auto-suggested or bulk	-80% effort
Long-form views from Shorts	Unmeasured, limited	Tracked, optimizable	+40% (estimated)

Success Metrics

Success Metrics

Primary Metrics (North Stars)

Metric	Baseline	Target	Timeframe	Measurement
Shorts-to-tutorial CTR (cooking, India)	~4.5% (global proxy)	6.0%	6 months	% of "Watch Full Recipe" clicks / cooking Shorts impressions
Tutorial watch time from Shorts referral	Unknown (no tracking)	+40% vs pre-launch	6 months	Minutes watched on tutorials accessed via Shorts
Saved content → tutorial conversion	Unknown	25% within 7 days	6 months	% of saved cooking Shorts where user watches linked tutorial

Secondary Metrics

Metric	Baseline	Target	Timeframe
"Full Recipe" badge tap rate	N/A (new)	8% of impressions	3 months
"Watch Full Recipe" button tap rate	~4.5% (current Related Video)	8%	3 months
End-of-Short prompt acceptance rate	N/A (new)	15% (of those shown)	3 months
Weekend notification tap rate	N/A (new)	12%	3 months
"Send to Kitchen" adoption	N/A (new)	5% of tutorial starts from mobile	6 months
% of cooking Shorts with Related Video	~30%	70%	6 months
Creator adoption of Funnel Analytics	N/A	40% of cooking creators view	6 months

Guardrail Metrics (Do Not Harm)

Metric	Threshold	Action if Breached
Shorts feed session length	No decrease >2%	Reduce prompt frequency
Shorts completion rate	No decrease >1%	Revise badge placement
Shorts feed satisfaction (survey)	No decrease	Review all UI changes
Casual browser engagement	No decrease in daily Shorts views for non-cooking viewers	Ensure targeting precision
Prompt dismissal rate	If >60%, reconsider triggers	Tighten intent signals

Segmented Analysis

Segment	Key Metric	Target
By language	CTR by Hindi / Tamil / Telugu / English	No language below 4.5% CTR
By city tier	CTR by Metro / Tier-2 / Tier-3	Tier-2/3 parity with Metro
By device	Adoption of "Send to Kitchen"	10% for users with CTV
By creator size	Related Video adoption	80% for creators >100K subs

1.

User Flow

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Survey [questions](#) and [output\(inputs from the masses\)](#) shared on the drive folder.